

GUIDELINE TO THE POWERPOINT PRESENTATIONS FOR THE DISSERTATION WORKSHOP

Title

One slide

CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

- ☐ One or more slides
- ☐ Give all the necessary background information so that when you explain your Problem Statement/Research Objectives and Research Questions these can be understood in the appropriate context.
- ☐ Define important terms using citations. Any definition should be supported by references to authorities.
- ☐ It should not be too long.
- ☐ Details would be covered in the Literature Review or in later chapters.
- ☐ Major statements made should be substantiated by references.
- ☐ Do not include references to your “solution” or your “objectives”, this would be done in later headings.
- ☐ Focus on what is relevant to understand your work.

1.2 Problem Statement

- ☐ One slide
- ☐ It should not be very long, rather it should be precise and to the point.
- ☐ Do not give background information (this would have been done already in the Introduction).
- ☐ Do not give the solution (the solution is not the problem!).
- ☐ In principle, do not state “several” problems as this is likely to make your research confusing. One problem only.

- ☐ Who has the problem? Who is the main actor(s)?

1.3 General Objective

- ☐ One slide
- ☐ Main objective of work from a broad perspective.

1.4 Research Objectives

- ☐ One slide
- ☐ Typical objectives:
 1. Understand the problem;
 2. Understand previous research and current related solutions, frameworks, tools;
 3. Design, develop and test your solution;
 4. Validate your solution.

1.5 Research Questions

- ☐ One slide
- ☐ Research Objectives and Research Questions should be aligned.

1.6 Research Justification

- ☐ One slide
- ☐ Why your work will be useful and to whom?
- ☐ Why solving this problem will be useful?
- ☐ New knowledge?

1.7 Scope and Limitations

- ☐ One slide
- ☐ Scope:
 - Focus on the areas that you plan to cover on your research.
 - Describe areas that you will not cover in your work (e.g. geographical, technical platforms, etc.).
 - Include the platforms for which you will develop (e.g. Android, iOS, Windows, Linux, etc.).
- ☐ Limitations:
 - Can your research scale? Is it representative? Would it be applicable in other geographic locations? Is it only a Pilot?

- How would you collect data? How are you going to test?

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

- ☐ **Highlight headings only (Structure of the Chapter)**
- ☐ One or two slides
- ☐ Your literature review should be aligned with your problem statement and your research objectives.
- ☐ You should not review concepts or topics that are irrelevant to your research.
- ☐ Summary/Conclusions
 - Identify gaps
 - Identify frameworks, technologies, algorithms, tools that you may want to consider.

CHAPTER THREE: METHODOLOGY

- ☐ No limits to the number of slides
- ☐ How are you going to do your work: **how do you plan to achieve your objectives? How are you going to answer your research questions?**
- ☐ The methodology should align with the research objectives and questions stated in Chapter 1—i.e. explain what methodologies you are going to use to answer the research questions.
- ☐ Objective 1:
 - Literature Review
 - Analysis: Surveys, Interviews, etc. (See below under Objective 3)
- ☐ Objective 2:
 - Literature Review
- ☐ Objective 3:
 - Identify a Software Development Methodology
 - SW Analysis: Surveys? Data Collection. Research Instruments (Surveys, Interviews, etc.). Questionnaires. Sampling Methodology. Sample

Population and sample size. How will you identify functional and non-functional requirements? Independent/dependent variables?

- Design Tools, e.g. (e.g. Use Case, UML, DFD's, Sequence Diagrams, ERD's, Wireframes, etc.)
- Implementation: SW Frameworks, Development Languages, SW Tools, SW Environment
- Testing: Functional, User, Version, etc. **How?**

☐ Objective 4:

- How would you validate your solution? Does it solve the problem?
- Testing in a live/simulated environment?
- Survey with some users?

☐ Ethical Considerations/Approval

☐ You should explain the methodologies chosen and justify your choice.